

Cool Tweaks for FOSS Enthusiasts



Typically, Linux systems are very fast, yet many of us would like to speed them up even more. You may benefit by tweaking a Linux system to get better efficiency. Here are a few suggestions on how to do so.

Tweaks are simple or rarely used commands that can improve the performance of a system. There are some best practices that you can employ to get a smoother or improved performance. Of the tweaks suggested here, you can choose to follow all or just some of them.

Reducing the load time of default Grub

The boot time refers to how long the system takes to select and load the default OS during startup. By default, the Grub load time is 10 seconds,

which means you have to sit idle for 10 seconds while the system starts booting. You can cut down this time by simply applying the following command:

```
sudo gedit /etc/default/grub &
```

And change GRUB_TIMEOUT=10 to GRUB_TIMEOUT=2. This will change the boot time from 10 seconds to 2 seconds. Do avoid putting '0' as this will not allow you to select any recovery options. After changing the time, you have to update Grub by

using the following command:

```
sudo update-grub
```

Using *apt-fast* instead of *apt-get* for a speedy update

apt-fast is a shell script wrapper for *apt-get*, which improves the update and package download speed by downloading packages from multiple connections, simultaneously. If you frequently use a terminal and *apt-get* to install and update packages, you may want to give *apt-fast* a try.

Install *apt-fast* via the official PPA using the following commands: